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PHOTOS BY PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

A woman blew a whistle in the face of an ICE officer, across from the Fairfield By Marriott, in New Bedford this week.

New tone in ICE surge

On South Coast, advocates say arrests becoming more indiscriminate

By Sean Cotter,
Omar Mohammed,
and Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

NEW BEDFORD — They could have been scenes from last year's immigration enforcement surges: Roofers arrested by US Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents outside Cumberland Farms. Workers grabbed near the seafood processing plants downtown. Someone cuffed at the Market Basket after dropping off a relative.

But these arrests happened this week, as ICE agents swarmed the South Coast, arresting more than two dozen people in New Bedford alone, ac-



An ICE agent took handcuffs off a woman before releasing her after she had been detained in New Bedford Tuesday.

cording to lawyers, in what appears to be a coordinated operation in an area with a large immigrant population and a memory of intense enforcement. And

►Family laments lack of progress on investigation of Maine ICE shooting. B1.

the arrests, lawyers and advocates for immigrants say, appear more indiscriminate than even in the height of the operations of last year.

In 2025, the Trump administration spun up a deportation machine capable of efficiently arresting, processing, and de-

ICE, Page A7

In 6th District, Koh seeks middle lane

Says Democrats 'get in a lot of trouble' with labels

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

As candidates across the ballot try to cram themselves — or others — into clear ideological buckets, the Democratic nominee for Massachusetts' Sixth Congressional District is doing something different in the

general election: He's being, well, very general.

Dan Koh, the Biden White House alum who emerged from a crowded Democratic primary, ran on an anti-Trump platform, leaning on his experience working for famous Democrats and a field-leading war chest. But he won the nomination without ascribing to a particular wing of his party — even as competitors boasted about their progressive credentials — and still doesn't.

Koh declined to call himself a

progressive, saying he would "let other people label" him, even as he supports some of the left wing's major policies, from realizing a version of Medicare for All to abolishing the federal Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency. He's also praised some of the country's prominent Democratic socialists while emphasizing he himself is not one. And he's put little separation between himself and some more moderate stances espoused by the Biden ad-

KOH, Page A6

Jewish voters weigh possible pro-Palestinian mayor in Providence

By Christopher Gavin
and Steph Machado
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — The victory party had all the pieces of David Morales's campaign for mayor on full display: There were calls for rent stabilization, vows to improve public schools, and promises to protect immigrants from federal agents.

But there were also nods to an issue 5,000 miles away: the war in Gaza. Before Morales came out to declare victory, the crowd cheered as speakers expressed solidarity with Palestinians and touted hoisting of the Palestinian flag on City Hall last year.

With Morales widely expected to prevail over Republican

Dave Talan in November, the prospect of a democratic socialist aligned with the pro-Palestinian movement atop the city has prompted fears in Providence's Jewish community — fueled further by a rise in antisemitism and a ballot question aimed at divestment from Israel also before voters this election. "We're all scared," said Alex

Cutler, a 46-year-old child psychiatrist who is Jewish and lives in Providence.

Across New England, antisemitic incidents reached record highs in the aftermath of the Oct. 7, 2023, attack by Hamas on Israel and the subsequent war in Gaza, according to the Anti-Defamation League. There

JEWISH VOTERS, Page A6



Current Providence Mayor Brett Smiley (left) and Democratic candidate for mayor David Morales.

Builders, cities still at odds on housing

Rising costs add strains to affordability requirements

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

For years, Greater Boston developers have repeated the same complaint: City-mandated affordable housing requirements, however well intentioned, are bad for business, cutting into their bottom lines by requiring builders to set aside units at below-market rents.

But now, amid a slump in new construction, their complaints are finding a more receptive audience — to a point.

Earlier this year, Waltham and Chelsea lowered their targets for affordable housing units that are built under what's known as inclusionary zoning, in hopes of getting shovels in the ground again.

While Boston, Cambridge, and Somerville have yet to follow suit, some councilors in those cities have publicly challenged their officials to be more flexible in their various requirements.

So far those cities aren't budging, saying the

HOUSING, Page A10

Contractor accused of \$8m fraud

Utilities say he cheated Mass Save on heat pumps

By Stephanie Ebbert
GLOBE STAFF

A South Shore heating and air conditioning contractor is accused of defrauding Massachusetts ratepayers of nearly \$8 million in Mass Save funds by improperly pocketing rebates for heat pumps that were never installed, installed improperly, or installed and later removed.

The utilities that manage Mass Save, the energy-efficiency program mandated by state law, filed suit in Plymouth Superior Court on Monday, seeking to recover the money from MWD Heating & Air Conditioning and its owner, Mark Dyszczyk of Rockland.

Mass Save, one of the most ambitious programs of its kind in the country, is funded by surcharges added to Massachusetts ratepayers' utility bills. With a budget of more than \$1 billion a year, it offers home and business owners rebates and discounts to make buildings more energy-efficient and convert from heating systems that use greenhouse gases to cleaner energy.

FRAUD, Page A10

A federal judge weighing whether to block President Trump's ban of three news outlets from White House grounds expressed some skepticism in response to the government's defense of the move. A2.

Iran's president delivered a defiant speech at the United Nations, vowing his country would defend itself until "its last breath." A4.

The usual bluster

Thursday: Breezy, some sun.
High: 61-66. Low: 52-57.

Friday: Clouds, rain.
High: 62-67. Low: 53-58.
Comics and Weather, D4-5.

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